Snafu & Fubar

COMMERCIAL NOTE 01

Understanding the Pricing Structure

How an inquiry is scoped, what determines its cost, and what clients can expect from a defined engagement.

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INTRODUCTION — A proportionate framework

Intelligence is not a one-size-fits-all service. Every investigation begins with a question. The cost of answering it depends on what needs to be established, the depth of research required, the complexity of the subject, and the form in which findings must be communicated.

Snafu & Fubar defines engagements that are proportionate to the question, transparent in scope, and clear about intended output. A focused research brief is fundamentally different from a multi-layered investigation involving numerous sources, competing explanations, technical questions, or strategic consequences.

FOUR LEVELS OF ENGAGEMENT — Starting-price structure

The following framework establishes four engagement levels. The level indicates the shape of the work; the final fee is fixed in writing once the question and scope are agreed.

01 — EXPLORE · Research Brief — from £750

A focused investigation into a defined question. Designed for clients needing a clearer picture of a development, claim, organisation, market question, or emerging issue.
Output: Concise research briefing examining available accounts and identifying core uncertainties.

02 — UNDERSTAND · Specialist Assessment — from £2,500

An extensive assessment examining a broader situation, relationship, or organisational question involving multiple information sources, dependencies, risks, or competing interpretations.
Output: Structured picture of the situation, supporting evidence, and key risk indicators.

03 — DECIDE · Strategic Perspective — from £5,000

For complex work tied to consequential decisions requiring independent research, structured analysis, and evaluation of assumptions, alternatives, and potential implications.
Output: Evidence review, comparison of competing explanations, and decision advisory support.

04 — ENGAGE · Workshops & Sessions — quoted per engagement

Facilitated sessions bringing key stakeholders together to examine evidence, challenge assumptions, and evaluate the strategic implications of a complex situation.
Output: Structured executive session, custom scenario framing, and actionable workshop summary.

Note: Fees are quoted in GBP, exclusive of VAT or other applicable taxes. Every engagement is confirmed as a fixed fee in a written proposal before work begins.

SIX FACTORS — What determines the cost

Six factors determine where an inquiry sits on the ladder and what it will cost. They are assessed during the scoping stage, before any fee is fixed.

- **01 · Scope Precision.** How precisely the central question can be defined, and the total number of sub-issues that must be investigated.
- **02 · Research Depth.** The overall volume, diversity, specialisation, and complexity of the raw material to be analysed.
- **03 · Analytical Complexity.** Requirements for independent corroboration, source comparison, timeline reconstruction, or competing-hypothesis analysis.
- **04 · Reporting Format.** The depth of required documentation, visual presentation, supporting evidentiary appendices, and executive briefings.
- **05 · Stakeholder Involvement.** The degree of direct interaction required, including expert interviews, advisory discussions, workshops, or inter-team coordination.
- **06 · Time Constraints.** Accelerated deadlines or urgent response requests that materially alter research workflows or resource allocation.

HOW AN ENGAGEMENT IS SCOPED — Five steps to commencement

- **Initial Brief.** The client sets out the core question, context, and purpose of the inquiry.
- **Scope Assessment.** We evaluate the subject matter, available information, operational constraints, and resource requirements.
- **Written Proposal.** A formal document detailing proposed work, deliverables, fixed fee structure, key assumptions, and realistic timelines.
- **Commission Approval.** Investigation commences formally upon client acceptance of scope and commercial terms.
- **Research & Reporting.** Findings are delivered in accordance with the brief, explicitly highlighting verified facts, provisional findings, and unresolved questions.

WHAT CLIENTS SHOULD EXPECT — Integrity without theatre

Proportionality and transparency. The purpose of an intelligence engagement is not to manufacture certainty or guarantee a pre-determined conclusion. It is to examine a question systematically, assess available evidence, and communicate findings with absolute integrity.

Our final reports make clear what available information supports, where interpretations remain provisional, and which questions could not be resolved within the agreed scope.

Lawful methods only. Snafu & Fubar works from open and lawfully obtained sources. We do not conduct surveillance, hacking, pretexting, or covert human intelligence. Work respects applicable law, privacy, and confidentiality obligations.

Contact. To discuss an inquiry, please email SnafuAndFubar@protonmail.com.

INVESTIGATE. ANALYSE. ILLUMINATE.

DOCUMENT CONTROL — Provenance and review

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